

Torq Arena — Game Ideas, Graded

Idea-level scale: **Best** · **Good** · **Low** · **Cut** (was "Ignore" — renamed to Cut to match the Notion [games.csv](#) table; **TorqSiege**, **TorqCapture** and **TorqBall** sit outside the scale as **Ungraded**, pending their prototype gates — the collapse test, the zone-scoring bench test, and the ball/boards test (+ a separate Grabber bench test) respectively). Grades are a working read from our vetting — change in Notion/here as the event firms up.

Grading synced to Notion "Torq Arena — Game Ideas" (source of truth), 3 Sep 2026.

Game	It's basically	Type	Idea Level	How it plays	Why it works
TorqBall	Rocket League	Arena	Ungraded (pending ball/boards test)	Standalone tournament (group → knockouts → final); teams push a giant glowing ball into goals on a boarded pitch — Standard 2v2/3v3 (default), Duel 1v1 (tiebreaker/hype final), Big Party 4v4/6v6 (exhibition scrum); a boost system (Plow/Scoop/Grabber/Turbo/Magnet) earned off lit floor pads adds chaos for Big Party + the stretch Rumble mode	Zero skill wall + team energy + the poster/reel shot potential — the widest-appeal concept in the set, with a full standalone doc set (rulebook, ball/boards prototype gate, boost system, needs/cost roll-up); graded once the Ball & Boards Test (and the separate Grabber bench test) prove the physics, same treatment as TorqSiege/TorqCapture.
TorqFall	Fall Guys	Arena	Best	6–8 cars per heat through a chaos gauntlet (rulebook §2); elimination / first-to-finish	Chaos hides mistakes; huge throughput; overhead pile-up = content gold
TorqSiege	Castle build-and-smash	Arena	Ungraded (pending collapse test)	Teams build a foam/cardboard castle, opponents smash it with RC cars; topple the core	Best reel in the bank + no failure state; graded once the collapse test proves the physics
TorqCapture	Call of Duty objective modes	Arena	Ungraded (pending bench test)	Two teams fight over lit zones; occupy → hold the majority → the ring flips colour + ticks points; a 5-mode COD-style playlist (Domination / Hotzone / The Hill / Siege Point / Courier)	Only true team-vs-team game in the set — Red vs Blue + a live flip-colour map = built-in narrative + the content hero; graded once the bench test proves electronic zone-scoring

Game	It's basically	Type	Idea Level	How it plays	Why it works
~~Capture the Zone~~	Capture the Flag	Station	~~Best~~ → Superseded	~~Teams run objects to glowing base zones; most captures~~	Absorbed by TorqCapture (locked decision) — the flag-run survives as the Courier mode of the playlist; the shareable card is kept, the standalone game is retired
TorqSumo	Beyblade / Sumo	Arena	Good	Push rivals out of a ring; bracket → a final	Dead simple; a crowned final gives the day a climax
Balloon Battle	Splatoon-ish	Station	Good	Each car a balloon on a stick; pop rivals; last standing	Cheap, silly, instant; slow-mo pops
Torq Bowling	Bowling	Station	Low	Nudge a ball into foam pins; score the frame	Precision but forgiving; satisfying — but low spectacle
~~The Maze~~	Time-trial	Station	Cut	Solo run vs the clock through a neon maze; leaderboard	Cut — head-to-head games out-content it; maze eats floor for one car
~~Mini-Golf~~	Mini-golf	Station	Cut	Nudge a ball through a turf course into the hole	Cut — too slow/low-spectacle for a content-first #1

Run set: 1 Best (marquee — TorqFall) + 3 Ungraded/prototype-gated arenas (TorqSiege, TorqCapture, TorqBall — each a full standalone event once its gate passes) + 2 Good (run — TorqSumo, Balloon Battle). Torq Bowling (Low) = optional filler if floor/budget allows. Capture the Zone is **absorbed into TorqCapture** (survives as the Courier mode). Maze + Mini-Golf dropped. Renders + clips per game live in **renders/** and the game deck.

Verified + changelog (2026-09-06): added **TorqCapture** as an Ungraded (pending bench test) Arena game and struck **Capture the Zone** as Superseded → absorbed into TorqCapture's Courier mode (locked decision from [\[\[TorqCapture — Design Study v1\]\]](#); card kept, standalone retired). Updated the idea-level-scale note (TorqSiege + TorqCapture both sit outside the scale, pending their prototype gates) and the run-set summary. Mirrors the same change in the Notion [games.csv](#). Rebuild the Graded PDF from this source.

Second pass (2026-09-06, refresh): refreshed **TorqBall's** "How it plays"/"Why it works" cells to reflect its now-full standalone doc set — standalone tournament arc (group → knockouts → final), the v1 mode playlist (Standard/Duel/Big Party), and the boost system (Plow/Scoop/Grabber/Turbo/Magnet on lit floor pads) — matching [\[\[TorqBall — Rulebook\]\]](#) and [\[\[TorqBall — Design Study v1\]\]](#). No grade or type change.

Third pass (2026-09-06, examiner fix): corrected TorqBall's Idea Level/Type — it carries the identical unresolved, game-defining prototype gate (the Ball & Boards Test, plus a separate Grabber bench test — both stated in every TorqBall doc as "don't build until PASS") that puts TorqSiege and TorqCapture Ungraded, so TorqBall moves from **Best/Flagship** to **Ungraded (pending ball/boards test)/Arena**, matching the vault's own scale note (line 3) and the Notion [games.csv](#) row. Updated the idea-level note (line 3) and the run-set summary (line 21) to reflect only TorqFall as a currently graded Best game. TorqBall is promotable back to

Best once the Ball & Boards Test and the Grabber bench test PASS — flip it here with a dated note, the same convention used for TorqSiege/TorqCapture.